



HEIDI LEVINE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

A Palestinian boy stands near a car that was destroyed in clashes between the Palestinian Authority and militants in the city of Jenin.

A shaky audition for key role in Gaza

Palestinian Authority draws criticism from all sides over campaign to subdue militants in West Bank

BY CLAIRE PARKER

JENIN, WEST BANK — The Palestinian Authority recently took a high-stakes gamble in this restive city, launching a major military operation aimed at clipping the wings of militant groups that had grown in influence and audacity.

If the operation succeeded, Palestinian security forces would demonstrate they could maintain order not only in the parts of the West Bank they nominally control but also, if given the

chance, perhaps in Gaza as well. The role of the Palestinian Authority in governing Gaza is very much a live question as foreign powers and Arab states now debate the future of the war-torn enclave.

But the six-week campaign in Jenin, which lost momentum after Israeli forces intervened last month, ultimately came up badly short and exposed some of the challenges the authority would face in securing Gaza.

While the security forces arrested dozens of Iranian-backed fighters, high-profile militants remain at large.

The clashes highlighted how poorly equipped the Palestinian Authority security forces are compared with the groups they are seeking to subdue. The campaign also underlined questions about how far Palestinians would go to fight fellow Palestinians and whether the authority could maintain its popular legiti-

macy if it did so. Moreover, the events in Jenin revealed how Israel's actions, which include its own withering attacks on targets in the city, undermine the ability of the Palestinian Authority to exert its control.

The battle between the Palestinian security forces and an umbrella group of fighters in Jenin led by Palestinian Islamic Jihad left 15 dead, including at least six civilians, and dozens injured, a spokesman for the authority's forces said.

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Gaza plan: Arab leaders meet to find alternative to Trump proposal. A11

U.S. attorney talked about targeting foes of Trump

Observers say Martin is following through on threats made in podcasts

BY SPENCER S. HSU

In the two years before he became D.C.'s top federal prosecutor, interim U.S. attorney Ed Martin publicly discussed investigating high-profile Justice Department officials who played a role in bringing charges against President Donald Trump and his allies.

In scores of his personal podcasts from August 2023 to January, Martin amplified Trump's claims — not supported by available evidence — that charges against him were made to damage him politically, and that prosecutors may have violated federal criminal conspiracy laws, department policies or legal ethics rules. The conversations on Martin's "Pro America Report" podcast and related radio show often revolved around Trump's desire for "retribution" against current or former department prosecutors.

After one month in office, Martin appears to be following through, taking actions that have alarmed lawyers inside and outside his office who say he's lever-

SEE MARTIN ON A4



ELIJAH NOUVELAGE FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Rep. Richard McCormick (R-Georgia) takes a question during a Thursday town hall in his district.

At town halls, DOGE is all the rage

Voters are confronting GOP House members about federal workforce cuts

BY HANNAH KNOWLES

ROSWELL, GEORGIA — The crowd packed into City Hall and filled an overflow room with one question, above all, for their Republican congressman: What did he think of Elon Musk's slash-and-burn mission to shrink the federal government?

Their Atlanta suburb in a solid-red district was hardly a hub of the liberal resistance, but hundreds had shown up to confront Rep. Richard McCormick in person. Now each argument from the lawmaker brought a new round of shouts, groans and boos.

"If you're going to just yell at me, that's not going to be an effective town hall," McCormick said,

five minutes into defending Musk's U.S. DOGE Service.

"But we're pissed!" a woman shouted. Town halls this week for congressional Republicans from Georgia to Oregon grew testy as voters showed up to vent, outraged at the firing of workers and the Department of Government Efficiency's access to sensitive data. Protesters showed up around the country at lawmakers' offices.

The backlash extends far beyond federal workers in the Beltway, reaching purple districts that will decide control of Congress in 2026 and swing states like Georgia that helped return Trump to

SEE DOGE ON A2

Joint Chiefs chair, other leaders fired in Pentagon purge

TRUMP RESHAPING FORCES' HIGHEST RANKS

Navy's top admiral, Air Force general also dismissed

BY MISSY RYAN
AND DAN LAMOTHE

The Trump administration abruptly dismissed the chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff and other senior officers on Friday night, as the Pentagon moves to bring the military's leadership in line with its "America First" agenda.

In a post on social media, President Donald Trump said he would replace Air Force Gen. Charles Q. Brown Jr. and would take the unusual step of tapping a little-known, retired three-star officer, Lt. Gen. Dan "Razin" Caine, as the next chairman.

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, in a statement distributed shortly after Trump's post, said he would dismiss five other senior officers, including Adm. Lisa Franchetti, the first woman to serve as chief of naval operations, and Gen. James Slife, a top Air Force officer.

"Under President Trump, we are putting in place new leadership that will focus our military on its core mission of deterring, fighting and winning wars," Hegseth said.

Hegseth informed Brown, who was in Texas on Friday for a visit to the southwest border, that he was being removed before Trump's announcement, said a

U.S. defense official, speaking on the condition of anonymity to discuss the leadership shake-up. The vice chairman of the Joint Chiefs, Adm. Christopher Grady, is expected to serve as acting chairman until Caine can be confirmed.

Brown, a veteran pilot and battlefield commander whom Trump nominated during his first term in office to become the Air Force's first African American chief of staff, was roughly 16 months into what was expected to be a four-year term. He was elevated to the military's top position by President Joe Biden in 2023, making him the second Black man to hold the chairman's job. Gen. Colin Powell was the first.

The dismissals comes as Trump's campaign to whittle down the federal workforce triggers court challenges and chaos for government workers, and his shifts on foreign policy, including an embrace of Russia's narrative about the war in Ukraine, stoke confusion and anxiety among U.S. allies.

The firings appear to represent the most significant move yet in the administration's emerging campaign to purge the Pentagon of what Hegseth has derided as "woke" policies and personnel

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ICE shake-up: Leader is removed amid push to boost arrests. A6

Refugees: Aid groups struggle after halt to reimbursements. B1

Musk's tactics leave senior U.S. officials unnerved

Trump's DOGE support limits Cabinet members' ability to oppose group

This article is by Jeff Stein, Jacqueline Alemany, John Hudson, Laura Meckler and Dan Diamond

Top treasury officials have complained about disruption. The secretary of state has pushed back on staff cuts. Inside the Education and Health and Human Services departments, political appointees have been informed — not consulted — about canceled grants and contracts, sometimes learning about decisions from the media.

Elon Musk's aggressive tactics to reshape the federal government have irritated and blindsided many senior officials in the Trump administration, including those tasked with running Cabinet departments being squeezed by his U.S. DOGE Service, according to interviews with more than 30 current and former officials and their advisers, many of whom spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss internal matters. Amid these bubbling tensions, White House Chief of Staff Susie Wiles personally asked Musk last week to better coordinate on DOGE's sweeping actions.

The broad goals of Musk's team at DOGE, which stands for Department of Government

SEE MUSK ON A7

Companies reframe DEI to put focus on 'leveling'

Attention shifts from identity to stay out of White House's crosshairs

BY TAYLOR TELFORD

President Donald Trump's campaign to stamp out diversity, equity and inclusion policies is spurring many businesses to rapidly recalibrate how to ensure equal opportunity within their ranks, trading programs framed around race and identity for those rooted in business outcomes.

Trump's orders last month dismantling federal DEI policies and programs sparked upheaval and layoffs across the federal workforce while telegraphing similar aims for the private sector. Companies have taken notice: this week, Pepsi, KPMG and Citigroup joined the ranks of firms retiring workforce representation goals. Accenture, Deloitte and Google took similar steps last week, while Goldman Sachs announced it would ditch a requirement for corporate boards of directors to include women and people of color, citing "legal developments."

Seeds of enforcement are beginning to manifest, with Comcast becoming one of the administration's first targets. In a Feb. 11 letter, Federal Communications Commission chair Brendan Carr notified the media giant that he

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L.A. fire chief ousted The city's mayor said the dismissal came in part because the department was not properly prepared ahead of last month's devastating blazes. A3

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